

Fadercraft Control XL — Quickstart

Thanks for getting Control XL — a Max for Live device that turns your Novation Launch Control XL MK3 into a performance instrument, with switchable Mixer and Instrument layers, dual encoder banks per channel, and instant cross-mode switching.

What's in this bundle

- `XL_Performance.amxd` — the Max for Live device. Everything it needs is self-contained, with no additional files required.
- `custom-modes/` — 15 Custom Modes for your controller (1–10 Instrument, 11–14 Mixer, 15 Cue).
- `Router/` — a preconfigured Ableton project (the device on a track with MIDI routing already set up). Open it, then drag the track into your own project.
- `Control XL Starter Set/` — a ready-to-use Ableton project for exploring the full workflow.
- This Quickstart guide.

Requirements

- Ableton Live 11 or later — Suite, or Standard with the Max for Live add-on.
- Max for Live 8.5 or newer.
- Novation Launch Control XL MK3.
- macOS or Windows.

Setup (about 5 minutes)

1. LOAD THE CUSTOM MODES ONTO YOUR LCXL MK3

Open Novation Components, connect your controller, and load the modes from `custom-modes/`.

- Modes 11–14 (Mixer) — required. The device uses these layouts for mixer operation.

- Modes 1–10 (Instrument) — optional. You can use the included layouts or your own. The only requirements are:
 - Cross-mode jump on `CC47`
 - Undo on `CC45`
 - Redo on `CC46`
- Mode 15 (Cue) — optional. Load it if you'd like the Prelisten shortcut to open the included cue layout.

2. ADD THE ROUTED TRACK

Open `Router/Router.als`. It already contains the device and all required MIDI routing.

Drag the track into your own set, or open the `Control XL Starter Set` project to explore the complete workflow.

3. ROUTING REFERENCE (IF CONFIGURING MANUALLY)

On the track that contains the device:

- MIDI From → All Ins · All Channels
- MIDI To → Launch Control XL MK3 (DAW) · Ch. 7
- Monitor → In

If these settings are incorrect, the device will not receive MIDI from the controller.

4. PLAY

Switch modes on the controller and the device display will automatically follow the active mode. Cross-mode switching lets you move between Instrument and Mixer layers instantly.

Using it

CROSS-MODE JUMP

Press `CC47` to jump between Instrument modes (1–10) and Mixer modes (11–14). The device remembers exactly where you left off and returns you there.

MOMENTARY OR TOGGLE

Hold a switch for temporary access to another layer, then release to return. Press and release normally to stay on the new layer.

The same hold-or-toggle behavior is used for Page and Bank switching.

TWO ENCODER BANKS PER CHANNEL

Each channel provides two encoder banks:

- Bank A → Encoders 1–3
- Bank B → Encoders 4–6

This effectively gives each channel six encoder assignments while keeping the layout easy to remember.

PRELISTEN

Jump to the Cue layout (Mode 15) and back to your previous mode. For now the cue layout maps one fader to the prelisten track volume, plus scroll up and down — this mode will gain more features over time.

UNDO / REDO

Mapped to:

- CC45 → Undo
- CC46 → Redo

ON-SCREEN CONTROLS

The on-screen controls (Daw, Prelisten, Page, Bank, and Mixer tabs 11–14) mirror the hardware controls, allowing you to switch modes directly from the device interface.

Updates

When a newer version is available, a New Version label appears at the top of the device.

Click it to open the download page and install the latest release. Gumroad also sends an updated download link by email whenever a new version is published.

Troubleshooting

THE CONTROLLER DOESN'T RESPOND, OR MODES DON'T SWITCH

In most cases, the MIDI routing is incorrect.

If you're using the included `Router.als`, everything is already configured. Otherwise, verify that:

- MIDI From → All Ins · All Channels
- MIDI To → Launch Control XL MK3 (DAW) · Ch. 7
- Monitor → In

Need help?

Questions or issues?

Email support@fadercraft.com and we'll reply within 48 hours on working days.